

Character Overview:

Name: Francesca Panettiere

Nickname/Alias: Fran, "fighting name"

Age: 21 y/o

Gender: Female

Pronouns: She/Her/Hers

Occupation/Role: Baker, Granddaughter, Player Character, Torch-Bearer

Faction/Group: Magical Lineage

Location: New York

Archetype: Successor, Hearthkeeper, Brawler with a Heart, Caregiver; *A strong-hearted successor shaped by community, care, and tradition.*

One-Sentence Summary: Francesca Panettiere is a warm, headstrong baker who pours her heart into her community by day and carries her family's bread golem fighting legacy into the arena by night.

Visual Identity

Height: 5'3"

Build: Hourglass, medium-build

Clothing Style: 80's-inspired workwear, baggy pants, rolled up sleeves

Distinguishing Features: Dark brown, thick, curly hair, chocolate brown eyes, olive skin tone

Accessories: golden hoop earrings, gold bangle bracelets, Francesca's apron

Color Palette/Motifs:

Posture/Body Language: Good/confident posture overall, but can get very animated when talking about something she's passionate about or people she's comfortable with like family and friends.

First Impression: Fran's first impression is a short, confident baker with thick dark curls and warm olive skin, dressed in loose 80s workwear, gold hoops, and an apron that's always been through something. She stands with steady posture like someone used to responsibility.

Core Personality

Positives/Negatives: (+) Hardworking, Kind-Hearted, Confident, Handy, Loyal, Protective (-) Stubborn, Workaholic, Has trouble asking for help, Overcommits herself, impatient at times

Habits & Mannerisms: Mind moves so fast she will start so many tasks at once so from the outside, it looks like she's made a mess and is all over the place. Italian cheek-to-cheek kisses that tend to surprise non-Italians. Would rather fix something than buy and replace it. Dances, sings, and hums while baking; you can find her dancing around the bakery kitchen.

Likes: Pop culture, food, music, dance, helping others/volunteer work, quiet nights at the bakery, family

Dislikes: bullies/people who are rude, wastefulness, complacency

Fears: letting others down, being a failure

Core Motivation: The pride she has for her family, the joy she gets from helping others

Narrative Function

Role in Story: Main Character

Relationship to Player: Player Character

Relationship with Nonna: Fran deeply admires Nonna for not only the legacy she's built with the bakery but for raising Fran all on her own. Fran takes pride in continuing this tradition, but she is worried about whether she can carry it the same as Nonna did and keep the community supported and happy as she did.

Themes They Reinforce: Strength, Community, Inherited Tradition, Craftsmanship

Internal Conflict: Living up to Nonna's legacy while trying to discover what kind of baker and arena fighter she is. Fran keeps herself constantly moving because slowing down means finally having to feel the weight of the pressure she carries.

External Conflict: Rising up the ranks in the golem championship

Gameplay Integration

System Hooks: Baking bread golems with customizable ingredients that unlock different abilities, encouraging players to experiment with fighting styles while balancing cozy bakery management and fast-paced arena combat.

Player Choices Affecting Them: The choice of the golem they bake for fight nights (where they know who their opponent is ahead of time) can affect how the fight goes based on abilities from said golem. Perks chosen from winning fight nights can also affect gameplay in both the arena and the bakery.

Voice and Dialogue

Speech Style: Expressive, conversational. Fran speaks quickly when excited, often speaking with her hands moving just as much as her mouth. She teases affectionately with those she's close to and bakery regulars. She talks to her dough very calmly as if it can already hear her before it's alive. She tends to hide her stress behind humor and sarcasm.

Common Phrases: "You look exhausted. Hang on." "Nobody leaves hungry, alright?" "I got it, I got it!" "Good things take time...unfortunately." "C'mon, keep up." "That all you got?" "I fixed it. Mostly." "No, no, it was *supposed* to do that."

Dialogue Samples:

Greeting: "You hungry? Yeah? Sit down, I'll bring something out." "Oh, good, you're here. Hold this for me for a second."

Emotional Moment: "The bakery feels different when I'm the one running it. The music's louder, the kitchen's messier, people stay later... I used to think that meant I was doing something wrong. Like inheriting all of this meant I was supposed to become you. But I'm starting to realize maybe that's not what this place was ever built on. It doesn't feel alive because everything stayed the same. It feels alive because everybody who loved it left something of themselves behind. You did. Mom did. The neighborhood did. And maybe now... it's my turn to do the same."

Conflict Line: "You don't get to walk in here and disrespect my people." "You wanna fight me, fine. Leave everybody else out of it."

Humor/Sarcasm: "I'm *pretty sure* that sound is normal." "I swear the kitchen gets messier when I clean it."

Environmental Storytelling

Personal Space: A crowded but deeply lived-in bakery kitchen where every object feels repaired, reused, or emotionally important. The space is warm, loud, flour-covered, and constantly in motion.

Important Objects: Mixers and Ovens, Bread Golem Mold, Nonna's Recipe Book

Hidden Details: Mess swept to the side to be out of the way, flour stains on the countertops, notes around the bakery to remind her to do certain things (opening/closing notes, reminder to eat, etc.), community and family photos and momentos all around the bakery, repaired appliances held together with tape and care, flour all over the place, tiny bread roll minions helping around the back of house.

Extra Notes:

Nonna's ring name: Il Mattarello ("The Rolling Pin")

Nonna: born 1919

Mother: born 1939

Fran: born 1961

Nonna came to America shortly after she had her daughter (Fran's mother)

Father was never in the picture, and the mother died from childbirth complications

Mother insisted on naming her after her mother before she passed

She also left a cassette tape behind of her singing for her daughter for Fran to listen to

Grandmother raised Fran; Fran slept in the bakery back room, learned to walk in the bakery.

Fran Character Traits and Habits:

- Warm, loud, protective
- would absolutely stand between a stranger and a bully
- laughs easily, but fights seriously
- headstrong, not afraid to get her hands dirty
- talks, hums, sings to the golems as she bakes them
- sings and dances while prepping and baking
- hates letting people down, will run herself into the ground
- refuses to ask for help because "Nonna never did."
- she helps the neighborhood:
 - leaves bread on stoops when times are hard
 - feeds fighters who can't afford to eat

-neighborhood helps her too:

-lookouts warn her if trouble's coming

-people lie to inspectors

-the older people of the neighborhood argue about who's better nonna or our MC

**Little moodboard of pop culture Fran would be interested in

